

Oracle SQL*Plus Spooling Guide

Step-by-step tutorial on capturing session activity and query outputs into a text file

1 Connect to the Database

Open your terminal or command prompt and log into your Oracle database session using SQL*Plus:

```
[oracle@localhost u01]$ sqlplus

SQL*Plus: Release 19.0.0.0.0 - Production on Thu Aug 20 12:26:55 2026
Version 19.3.0.0.0

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Enter user-name: /as sysdba

Connected to:
Oracle Database 19c Enterprise Edition Release 19.0.0.0.0 - Production
Version 19.3.0.0.0
```

2 Configure Environment Settings

Turn off unnecessary formatting to keep the output clean (especially useful when generating CSVs or clean reports):

```
SQL> SET PAGESIZE 0
SQL> SET FEEDBACK OFF
SQL> SET TRIMSPOOL ON
SQL> SET LINESIZE 1000
```

3 Start the Spool Session

Specify the file path where you want to save the output. This opens the destination file and begins recording all terminal activity:

```
SQL> spool spool_details.txt
```

4 Execute Your Queries or Commands

Run any SQL statements, PL/SQL blocks, or DML updates. Everything printed to the terminal screen will be captured in the spooled file:

```
SQL>
```

```
SQL> select * from shaadmin.emp;
```

EMP_ID	NAME	SAL
10	Avijit	45600
20	Anil	45321
30	Chintu	56789
40	Ayesha	76000
50	Anjali	54325
60	Babli	78900

```
6 rows selected.
```

```
SQL>
```

```
SQL> update shaadmin.emp set sal=56900 where emp_id=20;
```

```
1 row updated.
```

```
SQL> commit;
```

```
Commit complete.
```

```
SQL>
```

```
SQL> select * from shaadmin.emp;
```

EMP_ID	NAME	SAL
10	Avijit	45600
20	Anil	56900
30	Chintu	56789
40	Ayesha	76000
50	Anjali	54325
60	Babli	78900

```
6 rows selected.
```

5 Stop the Spool Session

Close the spool session to flush the buffer memory and save all recorded data to disk:

```
SQL> spool off;
```

6 Verify Spool File Contents

Inspect the generated text file directly from the shell terminal using the cat command:

```
[oracle@localhost u01]$ cat spool_details.txt
SQL>
SQL> select * from shaadmin.emp;

  EMP_ID NAME                SAL
-----
    10 Avijit                45600
    20 Anil                  45321
    30 Chintu                56789
    40 Ayesha                76000
    50 Anjali                54325
    60 Babli                 78900

6 rows selected.

SQL>
SQL> update shaadmin.emp set sal=56900 where emp_id=20;

1 row updated.

SQL> commit;

Commit complete.

SQL>
SQL> select * from shaadmin.emp;

  EMP_ID NAME                SAL
-----
    10 Avijit                45600
    20 Anil                  56900
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    40 Ayesha                76000
    50 Anjali                54325
    60 Babli                 78900

6 rows selected.
```